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BEHAVIOUR SYSTEM 07

Weekend Eating Control Plan

Five disciplined weekdays undone in 48 hours. The system for eating normally on Friday night, Saturday brunch and Sunday family lunch.

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The maths nobody shows you

You're not failing. You're running a 500-calorie daily deficit for five days and a 1,500-calorie daily surplus for two. That's a net gain, and it's why the scale hasn't moved in four months.

Days	Daily balance	Weekly total
Mon–Fri (5 days)	–500 kcal	–2,500 kcal
Sat–Sun (2 days)	+1,300 kcal	+2,600 kcal
Net for the week		+100 kcal

Two days undo five. And the weekend does more damage than the calories alone: you sleep late, you skip training, you drink, and Monday starts in a hole. The goal is not a perfect weekend. It's a weekend that costs you **+400** instead of +2,600.

THE TARGET

You don't need to eat clean on Saturday. You need to keep the weekend surplus under roughly 1,200 calories total across both days. That's a full restaurant dinner and drinks — you just can't have it four times.

Name your actual pattern

- ☐ **The Friday release** — the week ends and so does every rule, from 8pm onwards
- ☐ **The brunch spiral** — wake at 11, eat a 1,200-calorie brunch at 1pm, hungry again by 5
- ☐ **The family lunch** — Sunday at parents' or in-laws', three servings and no exit
- ☐ **The Sunday-night dread eat** — snacking through the evening because Monday is coming
- ☐ **The delivery default** — nobody cooks on weekends, so everything is ordered in

Circle yours. You only need a plan for the one or two that actually happen to you.

The four rules

1 Two events, not two days

The core rule of the entire system. Before Friday, decide which **two meals** across the weekend are the free ones. The Friday dinner and the Sunday family lunch. Or Saturday brunch and Saturday dinner. Two.

Every other meal in those 48 hours is a normal plan meal. This single decision, made on Thursday, is worth more than everything else in this guide combined — because the failure mode isn't the big meal, it's the fact that the big meal has no boundary and bleeds into the next six.

2 Protect the anchors

Weekends collapse because structure disappears. Keep three anchors and the rest holds:

- **Wake within 60 minutes of your weekday time.** Waking at 11am deletes a meal and guarantees you overeat the rest of the day.
- **Eat a protein breakfast on both days.** Even before a brunch. Especially before a brunch.
- **Train on Saturday morning.** It sets the tone for 48 hours and it's the easiest session of the week to schedule.

3 Drink like it counts, because it does

Drink	Calories	Note
Large beer (650 ml)	~280	Two of these is a meal
Whisky 60 ml with soda	~140	The best-value choice
Gin and tonic	~200	The tonic is the problem, not the gin
Cocktail (mojito, LIIT, margarita)	300–500	Liquid dessert
Wine (150 ml)	~125	

Alcohol also lowers inhibition around food and wrecks sleep quality. The 1am biryani order is not a separate failure — it's a downstream effect of drink number four. **Set the number before you leave the house.**

4 Sunday night closes the loop

Twenty minutes on Sunday evening: a proper dinner, tomorrow's dabba sorted, gym bag packed, bed at your weekday time. This is what makes Monday automatic instead of another restart.

Situation playbook

Friday night drinks

Eat a real protein dinner at 7pm *before* going out. Set your drink number in advance. Order a starter you actually want instead of grazing three you don't. Water between drinks.

Saturday brunch

Eat eggs at home first. At the table order protein-led, take the bread once. If it's unlimited, treat it as one plate. Walk afterwards instead of going home to nap.

Sunday family lunch

The hardest one, because refusing food is refusing affection. Take everything you're offered — in small quantities. Fill on dal, sabzi and curd first. Accept dessert, eat half. Nobody is auditing you.

Weddings and functions

Eat protein before you go. Skip the starter circuit entirely — that's where 800 calories disappear invisibly. One plate at the main buffet. Two drinks.

The stuff that quietly costs you

- **Grazing while watching.** Four hours of a series with a bowl in hand is 600–900 calories you won't remember eating. Portion into a bowl, put the packet away.
- **"Finishing" for the family.** Leftover pizza, the last two gulab jamuns. It's a habit, not hunger.
- **Zero steps.** A weekend at home is often 2,000 steps against a weekday 8,000. That's a 1,000-calorie swing across two days before you eat anything.

Your weekend scorecard

- ☐ Chose my two events on Thursday
- ☐ Woke within an hour of weekday time both days
- ☐ Protein breakfast both days
- ☐ Saturday training done
- ☐ Stayed at or under my planned drink number
- ☐ 8,000+ steps both days
- ☐ Sunday night: dabba packed, bag ready, normal bedtime

Five of seven is a successful weekend. Aim there, not at perfection.

Reframe the whole thing

You are not "being good" Monday to Friday and "cheating" on the weekend. That framing is what creates the binge. There's one way you eat — and twice a weekend, you eat something excellent without measuring it. That's not a cheat. That's the plan working.